

Forum Lingo

Words such as "bump" to keep a thread active, and "flame" for heated arguments are common.

vBulletin

The official vBulletin forum is at www.vbulletin.com/forum/

TOOLBOX

brings additional confusion for the user who has to then look through multiple pages for the post. Fortunately, vBulletin creates a link for every single post and each one of them has a post number. You can find this next to every post on the right denoted as #____. Clicking on it opens a new tab or window with just that post. You can also copy this URL and send it to your friends.

have a larger screen, the images are resized to that width or height. Scroll down to Thread Display Options in the User CP and look for the Image Resizer. Here you can mention the width and height of your desktop so that the images can be resized. It's advisable to specify a slightly lower resolution than the desktop itself.



Thread length

Long threads go on forever and switching from page to page can be slow and painful.

then enter a name for the album and give a description if required. Choose whether you want the album to be a private or a public album. Click Submit.

With the album created, now click on Upload Pictures. Click on Choose and select the images you want to upload to your album. Click on Upload Pictures. To access the photo albums of other users, click on their username first and then on Statistics tab. If the user has photos uploaded, you will see a link called "Albums created by" and

Setting an avatar for the forum

Setting a limitation on number of posts displayed on a page



Adding a signature and avatar to your profile

The signature and avatar are images used to identify yourself to others in addition to the nickname that you use. Every forum has this feature and setting it up is rather simple. Like most of the controls, the signature and avatar can be set from the User CP menu. An easier way is to click on the Quick Links link so the dropdown menu appears. Click on Edit Signature.

Signatures can be plain text or a mix of an image with text. First, type the text in the large text box. Do not overdo or let the signature spill into several lines. To set an image as a signature, click on Choose file and browse and point to the signature image you have created. The limitation on the size of the image is 500 x 100 pixels. When creating the image in an image editor, start by creating a canvas of this size.

Avatars are set up on vBulletin in a similar manner. Under the User CP link, click on Edit Avatar. Once again, there is a limitation on the resolution of the avatar. In this case, it is 100 x 100 pixels.



Widescreen images

Attaching large high-resolution images into the thread isn't usually encouraged on forums. Users with slower connections have to wait a long time for the images to load and those with screens with low resolutions have to scroll a lot to view the images.

vBulletin automatically resizes the image resolution to fit your screen. By default, there is a setting put into your User CP. This can be modified so if you

This can be reduced by increasing the number of posts in a page. This is possible by changing the value of Number of Posts to Show Per Page in the Thread Display Options section under User CP. If the forum has lots of images and video components, then it's better to keep the posts per page to a minimum of, say, 10 to 15.



Choosing your editor preferences

Every forum has a simple posting utility at the bottom of every page. If you choose Advanced, you are then taken to a page with all the formatting controls displayed. There are also tools to add images, links, bullets, numbered lists, etc.

If you want a more detailed editor in the thread's page, then in the User CP, scroll down to Miscellaneous Editor Interface. Click on the dropdown for Message Interface Editor and choose the kind of editor you want.



Adding photographs

Like any other photo-hosting site, vBulletin has the option for users to add photographs. There is a limitation on the resolution of images uploaded though — 600x600 pixels. First, resize your images to this resolution before uploading them. Photos could be of your computer, of a recent trip, or anything else. Other members will be able to visit your photo gallery and leave comments.

First click on Quick Links > Pictures & Albums. To add your photos, you first need to create an album. Click on the Add Album link on the left,

the username. Click it and you will see the uploaded photos.



Using the advanced search

Forums are searchable and often a great source for information. It could be information on a problem you might be facing or you might need to verify whether a thread on the topic you are about to post already exists. The search function is available on the top bar in vBulletin. The advanced search gives better control and is useful if you are getting too many results and you need to filter them out.

Click on Search in the menu on the top of the page and click on Advanced Search at the bottom of the dropdown. Here, you can choose which sections of the forums vBulletin should search for. Hold down [Ctrl] and click on the sections in the list to the right. You can also search for posts by a particular user.



Quickly marking sections as read

Updates to the forum take place very often and you might find yourself looking through all the updated threads and sections a little difficult. Going to every thread and automatically marking it as read like an e-mail is impossible. Fortunately, vBulletin allows marking of entire sections of the forum as read — a simple double-click action. In the root of the forum, double-click on the icon next to the section name.

This is also particularly useful when you use the New Posts link to list all recently updated links and you are given a list of updated posts from all the sections. It's good to first select as read those sections in which